



Netflix new update

Netflix has finally added the option for users to remove shows from their "Continue Watching" list. <https://digit.in/mar25-27>



YouTube video player update

The new interface allows for easier access to full-screen, like or dislike, see comments, and share. <https://digit.in/mar25-28>

OnePlus Buds Z2

A worthy successor to the OnePlus Buds Z

OnePlus is no stranger to making fantastic audio products. The device we are reviewing here is the successor to the OnePlus Buds Z and is dubbed the OnePlus Buds Z2. Priced at the sweet spot under 5K, these earbuds feature a variety of improvements and additions over their predecessor. Is it worth its asking price? Let's find out.

BUILD AND COMFORT

Featuring a lightweight build with the earbuds weighing merely 4.6g, the OnePlus Buds Z2 is an excellent option to use on the go. The earbuds have a glossy finish with long stems and a CD-like design on the back of the buds that doubles as the touch control zone. They're not the most robust feeling earphones and do feel slightly cheap to the touch.

However, the earbuds are pretty comfortable to wear and provide a secure fit. OnePlus provides you with two additional silicone ear tips as well.

As for the charging case, the earbuds sit snugly in a pill-shaped case that is extremely easy to carry around. The front features an LED light while the back houses the USB Type-C port.

FEATURES

Despite being priced conservatively at ₹4,999, the OnePlus Buds Z2 is brimming with features. The headlining feature is Active Noise Cancellation. You can choose between regular and Max ANC using the HeyMelody app. While the ANC on these earbuds definitely doesn't come close to the premium heavyweights, it is pretty decent for the price. Low-frequency, constant sounds such as an AC's hum, a PC's whir and more are cancelled out pretty effectively but you'll easily be able to hear more erratic and high-frequency sounds such as traffic, human voices, and more. As for Transparency Mode, the earphones do a good job letting ambient sounds in, although it can sound artificial at times.



The HeyMelody app is compatible with both Android and iOS features. If you're using a OnePlus phone though, it is built into OnePlus' firmware. Those without OnePlus devices can leverage a fair number of features via the HeyMelody app such as viewing battery status, switching between noise cancellation modes, performing an earbud fit test, customising touch controls, and performing firmware updates. There is absolutely no way to integrate volume controls though, which is disappointing. The app is also missing a customisable EQ, so users pretty much have to make do with the bloated bass response of the earbuds.

If you use a OnePlus smartphone, you'll get access to a number of OnePlus exclusive features as well. First off, you get Dolby Atmos support that simulates a 3D soundstage and makes the sound more immersive. You will also get low latency gaming mode support that lowers the delay to merely 94ms.

The OnePlus Buds Z2 are rated IP55 dust and water-resistant making them excellent for outdoor use or when working out. Not only that, but the charging case is also rated IPX4.

PERFORMANCE

The OnePlus Buds Z2 comes equipped with 11mm drivers, an improvement

over its predecessor's 10mm drivers. As for audio codecs, the earbuds support the SBC and AAC formats.

The earbuds sound signature is heavily bass-biased with overemphasised highs as well, so the mids do tend to take a backseat in the mix.

The sound signature is lows-heavy and can sound boomy and muddy at times. While some consumers may enjoy this bass-forward sonic signature, especially with genres such as pop, rap, EDM, and Bollywood, purists or audiophiles will likely be turned off by the aggressive bass.

BATTERY LIFE

OnePlus has rated this device's battery life at 7 hours on the buds alone (without ANC), and a whopping 38 hours of playtime with the buds and charging case combined. In our tests, with ANC turned on and the volume levels set to 50 per cent, the buds lasted for 4 hours and 50 minutes.

OnePlus has also integrated Flash Charge that provides a whopping 5 hours of playback (case and earbuds combined) by just charging the earbuds for 10 minutes.



BUILD	74
FEATURES	82
PERFORMANCE	68
VALUE	75

VERDICT

The OnePlus Buds Z2 are one of the most complete all-rounders you can find under 5K with a plethora of features, excellent battery life, and good ANC. If you have a OnePlus device, you get Dolby Atmos support and low latency gaming mode as well. However, the sound quality is extremely bass-forward and will only appeal to bass lovers.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

COLOURS: Obsidian Black, Pearl White | WEIGHT: 4.6 g (earbuds) | DRIVER: 11 mm dynamic | WATER & SWEAT RESISTANCE: Earbuds: IP55, Charging case: IPX4 | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.2 | SUPPORTED CODECS: SBC, AAC | WIRELESS RANGE: 10 meters | PLAYBACK WITH ANC ON: Up to 5 hours | PLAYBACK WITH ANC OFF: Up to 7 hours | COMBINED PLAYBACK: Up to 27 hours (ANC ON), 38 hours (ANC OFF) | FLASH CHARGE: 10 mins for 5 hours

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